PRODUCT VISION / DISCUSSION SUMMARY

GoTradie

Make running a trade business feel almost effortless.

“You do the trade. We’ll do the paperwork.”

Executive summary. GoTradie is **not another accounting package**. It is a fast, forgiving companion that removes administrative friction from a tradie’s working day. Xero, Invoice Ninja, MYOB or another accounting platform handles the financial books; GoTradie simplifies the interaction, keeps richer operational context, and does as much of the repetitive work as possible.

1. The three guiding principles

01 **Easy to use**
Minimum steps, minimum typing, immediate practical value. A task should feel quicker with GoTradie than without it.

02 **Simple to understand**
Plain language and obvious actions. No need to understand GST codes, bookkeeping workflows or the accounting system underneath.

03 **Quick onboarding and re-onboarding**
Start quickly. Leave for a day, a month or six months, then return and do useful work straight away - without clearing a mountain of neglected admin.

2. The real problem is mental load

A carpenter wants to think about the next mahogany deck, not whether a packet of screws is “materials”, “consumables”, or a partial-business GST purchase. If the tool demands an accounting decision before allowing the user to work, the design has failed.

GTD-inspired rule: capture quickly, process quietly and make returning painless. Never punish someone for not using the system. Backlogs and exceptions must not block today’s work.

Where the work belongs

The tradie should not need to know which backend they are using. Clear ownership keeps the systems honest.

3. One owner per fact

Accounting platform	GoTradie
Authority on finance	**Authority on operational context**
Bills, invoices, payments, balances, GST, BAS, EOFY and the accounting ledger. Xero first; Invoice Ninja, MYOB and others later.	GPS logs, store branches, job context, travel, supplier information, receipt provenance, extra classifications and working notes.

The bridge: GoTradie matches its records to accounting records, uploads receipts, keeps allowed fields up to date, and verifies imports in bulk. It must not silently invent or overwrite financial facts.

4. The four core jobs

- **Set up once, then check for changes.** Initial setup should be quick. Routine configuration checks run quietly thereafter.
- **Submit purchases effortlessly.** Bought something at Bunnings? Retrieve the receipt automatically where available, attach it to the right purchase and deal with discrepancies in the background.
- **Invoice easily.** Turn captured jobs, labour, materials and relevant records into an invoice without re-entering the same information.
- **Quote easily.** Build a quote from prior jobs, known materials, prices and available supplier information.

5. What effortless automation looks like

Example - a Bunnings purchase: detect or receive the transaction; retrieve its PDF when available; identify supplier, store and invoice; match it to the correct accounting bill; attach the document; verify the total and file the context in GoTradie.

If Bunnings is unavailable: queue the missing receipt, keep the recorded facts, and let the user carry on. Show uncertainty clearly; never pretend a guess is verified.

A failure should produce one small, recoverable exception - not a questionnaire about GST while someone is standing in the timber aisle.

Build the experience first

The goal is a recommendation from one tradie to another: “What the hell? This is so bloody simple!”

6. What GoTradie could do next

- **Find materials nearby:** “Best price for the merbau decking lengths I need, in stock within 10 km of my current location.” Compare supplier prices and stock *when reliable information is available*.
- **Analyse work, not just money:** travel and GPS logs, time on jobs, task efficiency, material choices and what-if scenarios.
- **Work where tradies work:** eventually a fast, practical iOS and Android app, designed for short, interrupted sessions rather than desk-bound administration.

7. Architectural guardrails

- **Provider-independent core.** Build a small accounting adapter boundary; implement Xero first. Don’t build an elaborate compatibility framework before another provider is needed.
- **No second ledger.** GoTradie is not the financial authority. It can mirror and check figures, but should not create conflicting financial truth.
- **Safe synchronisation.** Match records reliably, avoid duplicate uploads, preview changes, log results and make corrections recoverable.
- **Unreliable suppliers are normal.** Missing PDFs, absent APIs and uncertain stock must not derail the user.
- **Fight feature creep.** A useful new capability is only a win if it does not make the everyday flow harder.

8. How to tell if it works

- A first-time user can complete a useful task without studying a manual or learning accounting terms.
- Someone returning after six months can complete a useful task within **30 seconds**, without first clearing overdue work. (Proposed acceptance test.)
- The system handles normal purchases without demanding repetitive human classification or receipt uploads.
- When automation cannot finish, the user can continue working and return to one clear, understandable exception later.

The defining rule

If a tradie has to think like an accountant to use GoTradie, we’ve failed.

Practical next slice: stabilise the Xero synchronisation, tracking metadata, PDF attachments and bulk verification; then tackle purchase capture, quoting and invoicing. Keep every slice small and useful.